

Kim Ridout, M.S., PMP®, REM®

Program & Project Leadership | Environmental Systems | Technical Integration

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Environmental and public-sector professional with 12+ years of experience spanning watershed protection, agricultural compliance, food systems, sustainability, and program management. Science Project Manager at The University of Texas at Austin's Jackson School of Geosciences, supporting the Associate Dean for Research and strategic research initiatives. Federal grant reviewer and panel chair with experience across four USDA competitive grant review cycles. Strong background in program and project management, structured proposal evaluation, stakeholder engagement, technical synthesis, data-informed decision-making, and cross-functional coordination, complemented by training in data engineering and analysis.

REVIEWER SCORING PHILOSOPHY

My approach to grant review is grounded in objectivity, consistency, transparency, and alignment with program intent. I evaluate proposals against applicable program criteria, including program alignment, feasibility, methodology, measurable outcomes, anticipated impacts, and application clarity. I apply criteria consistently, ground evaluations in application content, and prioritize fair and defensible decision-making across all reviews.

CORE CAPABILITIES

Program & Project Management • Strategic Planning • Cross-Functional Coordination • Stakeholder Engagement
Research & Technical Synthesis • Environmental Programs • Regulatory Operations • Executive Reporting
Process Improvement • Consultant Management • Community Engagement • Data-Informed Decision-Making
Systems Analysis • Data Integration • Technical Project Development

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Science Project Manager

Sep 2026 – Present

The University of Texas at Austin | Jackson School of Geosciences

- Support the Associate Dean for Research and strategic research initiatives involving faculty, research programs, external partners, and university stakeholders.

Application Reviewer & Panel Chair (Contract)

2022 – 2024 & 2026

United States Department of Agriculture | Agricultural Marketing Service (AMS) | Rural Business-Cooperative Service (RBCS)

- USDA AMS Local Food Promotion Program (LFPP) — 2022, 2023 & 2024 review cycles: Application Reviewer & Panel Chair
- USDA RBCS Meat and Poultry Processing Expansion Program (MPPEP) — 2026 review cycle: Application Reviewer
- Conduct structured, independent evaluations of competitive federal grant applications using program-specific scoring criteria and funding opportunity guidance.
- Assess program alignment, feasibility, project approach, budgets, measurable outcomes, anticipated impacts, and supporting documentation.
- As Panel Chair, facilitate reviewer discussions, support scoring consistency and consensus, and synthesize findings into clear panel summaries.
- Prepare concise, evidence-based written evaluations documenting application strengths, weaknesses, and scoring rationale while maintaining confidentiality, objectivity, and consistency.

Group Program Manager

Jul 2023 – Feb 2026

County of San Diego | Office of Sustainability and Environmental Justice

- Directed high-impact sustainability initiatives involving food access, water management, climate resilience, and implementation of County Board direction.
- Managed complex workplans, technical consultants, stakeholder engagement, and cross-departmental coordination while balancing policy, operational, and community priorities.
- Facilitated public roundtables, regional workshops, and interdepartmental working groups; communicated with executives, Board staff, community groups, and other stakeholders.
- Synthesized technical analysis and public input into executive reports, strategic recommendations, and public-facing deliverables.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE (CONTINUED)

Supervising Agricultural Standards Inspector

Apr 2021 – Jul 2023

County of San Diego | Department of Agriculture, Weights and Measures

- Supervised and trained agricultural water quality inspectors, reviewed inspection and investigation work, and coordinated program coverage and high-priority responses.
- Modernized program operations through data-informed prioritization, regulatory interpretation, process improvement, and operational planning.
- Created the Threat to Water Quality framework and expanded the regulated inventory from approximately 300 to more than 1,600 facilities while the inspection team grew from two to six staff.
- Coordinated with regulators, partner agencies, technical staff, and agricultural stakeholders; prepared outreach and annual regulatory reporting for leadership and the Regional Water Quality Control Board.

Agricultural Standards Inspector, Senior/Staff

Jan 2016 – Apr 2021

County of San Diego | Department of Agriculture, Weights and Measures

- Conducted inspections and investigations across agricultural water quality and statewide agricultural regulatory programs.
- Interpreted regulatory requirements, developed stakeholder outreach, and coordinated with partner agencies and County teams on complex compliance matters.
- Prepared program reporting, legislative analysis, and technical documentation supporting enforcement and regulatory decisions.

Compliance Aide

Jun 2015 – Jan 2016

County of San Diego | Air Pollution Control District

- Served as a liaison among the public, inspectors, and regulatory programs; coordinated complaint documentation, permit and equipment-breakdown tracking, regulatory reports, and enforcement support.

Park Attendant

Feb 2014 – Jun 2015

County of San Diego | Department of Parks and Recreation

- Supported park and preserve operations, environmental compliance and watershed-protection documentation, public safety, special events, and interpretive presentations.

Temporary Office/Data Support

Mar 2013 – Oct 2013

University of Virginia | Neurological Surgery and Psychiatry

- Performed confidential data entry, auditing, and record management for research datasets.

Student Laboratory Assistant

Jan 2009 – Aug 2011

California State University San Marcos | Phycology Laboratory

- Conducted molecular and microscopy research on nitrogen-fixing cyanobacteria, maintained laboratory cultures, and prepared a poster presented at the 2011 Phycological Society of America Annual Meeting.

SELECTED INITIATIVES & PROJECTS

Agricultural Water Quality Program Site Prioritization System

2020 – 2023

- Designed and managed the Threat to Water Quality framework, combining priorities across nine watersheds, Water Quality Improvement Plan information, inspection data, environmental risk, and operational considerations.
- Enabled defensible site prioritization, inspection planning, workload balancing, regulatory reporting, and long-term planning while the inventory expanded from approximately 300 to more than 1,600 sites.

Water Ways Report

2023 – 2025

- Managed consultants, stakeholder engagement, and cross-departmental workflows while synthesizing technical analysis, stakeholder perspectives, and public input.
- Directed final report development, review coordination, feedback integration, and finalization; the report was provided to the San Diego County Board of Supervisors in April 2025.

SELECTED INITIATIVES & PROJECTS (CONTINUED)

Food Justice Community Action Plan

2024 – 2026

- Coordinated stakeholder engagement and interdepartmental collaboration and led seven community meetings.
- Synthesized more than 1,500 public comments into over 200 community ideas and 20 potential County actions for a plan presented to the County Board of Supervisors on December 11, 2024.

MIT xPRO Professional Certificate in Data Engineering

Feb – Aug 2026

- Completed applied training in Python, SQL, ETL workflows, databases, APIs, Docker, data analysis, and predictive modeling.
- Selected projects include Housing Price Prediction Models and Retail Sales Time Series Analysis.

EDUCATION

M.S., Environmental Sciences & Policy

Johns Hopkins University | GPA 3.97

B.S., Biology

California State University San Marcos | GPA 3.866

Minor in Border Studies

CERTIFICATIONS & PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Project Management Professional (PMP®)

Registered Environmental Manager (REM®)

MIT xPRO Professional Certificate in Data Engineering

Microsoft Azure Fundamentals (AZ-900)

IBM Python for Data Science, AI & Development

IBM Introduction to Data Engineering

TECHNICAL TOOLS

Programming & Analysis: Python, SQL, Pandas, NumPy, Jupyter

Data & Databases: ETL, data modeling, PostgreSQL/PostGIS, MySQL, MongoDB, Cassandra, Redis

Geospatial: QGIS, GeoServer, ArcGIS

Development & Infrastructure: Docker, Git, GitHub, REST APIs, FastAPI, VS Code, Postman

Cloud & Data Platforms: Azure Fundamentals, Hadoop, Apache Spark, Apache NiFi, Apache Airflow

PUBLICATION

Stancheva, R., Sheath, R.G., Read, B.A., McArthur, K.D., Schroepfer, C., Kocielek, J.P., & Fetscher, A.E. (2013). *Nitrogen-fixing cyanobacteria (free-living and diatom endosymbionts): their use in southern California stream bioassessment*. *Hydrobiologia*, 720, 111-127.
doi.org/10.1007/s10750-013-1630-6